Q. Who is India's No. 1 stand-up comedian?



1 **KAPIL SHARMA**
38 [36.6]



2. **ZAKIR KHAN**
10.7 [8.9]



3. **SUNIL GROVER**
9.1 [9.6]



4. **AMIT TANDON**
6.9 [8.1]



5. **ANUBHAV SINGH BASSI**
6.3 [6.8]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 stand-up comedienne?



1 **BHARTI SINGH**
37.1
[37.2]



2. **MALLIKA DUA**
9.2 [8.2]



3. **SUGANDHA MISHRA**
8.3 [9.1]



4. **JEEYA SETHI**
7.6 [7.1]



5. **SHREEJA CHATURVEDI**
7.2 [5.8]

All figures in % ; rest, others; Feb. '24 figures in bold, Aug. '23 in [ ]; NA=no data

Streaming has given wings to the careers of fortysomething actresses who struggle to find significant roles on the big screen

where she had a key cameo role, stayed put in the #1 spot among heroines. The action-heavy films didn't do justice to Padukone's thespian credentials but they made optimum use of her striking screen presence.

Making her MOTN debut was Rashmika Mandanna who was in the news in the latter half of 2023 for being the most tolerant wife in *Animal* and for featuring in a viral deepfake clip that had the netas and *abhinetas* concerned about the perils of AI.

On the streaming front, Pankaj Tripathi continued as the favourite even if he didn't have a new web series in 2023. Instead, he had a feature in *Kadak Singh* (ZEE5); earned a National Award for best supporting actor for 2021 Netflix release *Mimi;* and steered *OMG2!* to the Rs 100 crore club. Giving him company in the top five were Manoj Bajpayee, whose powerful turn as a lawyer in *Sirf Ek Bandaa Kaafi Hai* (ZEE5) struck a chord, and Bobby Deol whose riveting turn as the malicious godman in *Aashram* played an instrumental role in him being cast as the much-beloved antagonist in *Animal*.

Sushmita Sen was in a league of her own, having a memorable 2023 anchoring two web series—*Taali* (JioCinema) and *Aarya* (Disney+Hotstar). The presence of Kajol (*The Trial*), Raveena Tandon (*Karmma Calling*) and Pooja Bhatt in the list shows how streaming shows have given wings to the careers of fortysomething actresses who, unlike their male counterparts, struggle to find significant parts on the big screen.

When it comes to who tickles the funny bone best, Kapil Sharma and Bharti Singh emerged as the unanimous favourites as No. 1 comedian and comedienne, respectively. ■